

SUDDEN DEATH — COMMERCIAL PREMISES

INCIDENT	25-03-0714	RECEIVED	00:00:47 07 MAR	GRADE	I — IMMEDIATE
LOCATION	MERIDIAN FINE ART	SUB-LOCATION	B2 / COLD STORE 3	UNITS	AM-114, AMB-27

CALL DATA

TIME	ENTRY
00:00:47	Call received. Caller: PRYCE, Oskar — Night Security Supervisor, Meridian Fine Art Storage & Conservation, 4 Halligan Wharf.
00:01:20	Caller states a member of staff is unresponsive in a cold store on the vault level. States he discovered the male "about quarter to twelve." Caller advised not to re-enter the store.
00:03:11	AM-114 and AMB-27 dispatched.
00:07:26	Units on scene. Admitted by caller at the Halligan Wharf lobby.

RESPONDING OFFICER NARRATIVE — PC 4471 D. AUMONT

On arrival I was met by the caller, PRYCE, who was alone in the building and appeared agitated. He conducted us to Vault Level B2 by the passenger lift.

Cold Store 3 is a sealed climate-controlled room off the B2 corridor. The door was standing open on our arrival and the store's climate panel was showing **FAULT — DOOR OPEN**. Signage on the door reads: **REDUCED OXYGEN ATMOSPHERE · 15% O₂ NOMINAL · MAXIMUM EXPOSURE 30 MINUTES · PERSONAL MONITOR REQUIRED**.

An adult male was lying prone in the centre of the store, approximately two metres inside the threshold, between two rows of flat storage cabinets. No signs of struggle. Nothing overturned. No blood. The deceased's spectacles were folded in his breast pocket.

At **00:11** paramedics relocated the male to the B2 corridor in order to attempt resuscitation in a breathable atmosphere. Resuscitation was attempted and discontinued. Life was pronounced extinct at **00:18** by AMB-27.

The male was identified by PRYCE and by the staff photograph on his lanyard as **RENN, Tobias**, 54, Head of Conservation.

B2 is badge-controlled. There is no sign of forced entry to the level, the store, or the building. A personal oxygen monitor of the type required by the door signage was found seated in its charging cradle in the B2 anteroom, fully charged and not deployed.

SCENE CONDITIONS

Ambient temperature at scene	20.8 °C
Location of temperature reading	B2 CORRIDOR, OUTSIDE COLD STORE 3
Time of temperature reading	00:29, 07 MAR
Relative humidity (corridor)	44%
Instrument	AMP-7 SCENE PROBE / CAL 11 FEB

Scene ambient forwarded to the Office of the Chief Medical Examiner on intake form ref. 25-03-0714 at 00:34.

PERSONS PRESENT

NAME	CAPACITY	DETAINED
PRYCE, Oskar (44)	Night Security Supervisor — caller, sole occupant on arrival	No
MARCHETTI, Vivienne (51)	Facility Director — attended 01:20 following notification	No

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

Deceased entered a posted reduced-oxygen environment without the required personal monitor. No indication of third-party involvement at this time. Scene released to CID pending post-mortem. **Provisional classification: NON-SUSPICIOUS — PENDING OCME.**

POST-MORTEM EXAMINATION

CASE	OCME 25-0412	DECEDENT	RENN, TOBIAS	AGE / SEX	54 / M
POLICE REF	25-03-0714	EXAMINED	07 MAR, 09:15	EXAMINER	DEP. ME S. OKONJO

EXTERNAL EXAMINATION

Well-nourished male of stated age. No external trauma. No ligature furrow, no petechial haemorrhage of the conjunctivae or oral mucosa, no injury to the mouth or nares. No defensive injuries to the hands or forearms. Fingernails intact; nail beds cyanotic. No injection sites. No burns or chemical injury to skin, mouth or airway.

INTERNAL EXAMINATION

Marked pulmonary congestion and oedema. Right ventricular dilatation. Cerebral oedema. Moderate coronary atherosclerosis with 40–50% narrowing of the left anterior descending artery — chronic, and consistent with the decedent's documented history. No acute thrombus, no myocardial infarction, recent or healed. Airway patent throughout; no obstruction, no aspirate, no soot or thermal injury.

TOXICOLOGY

SCREEN	RESULT	SCREEN	RESULT
Ethanol	Not detected	Carboxyhaemoglobin	1.1% (normal)
Opiates / opioids	Not detected	Cyanide	Not detected
Benzodiazepines	Not detected	Volatile solvents	Not detected
Stimulants	Not detected	Prescribed cardiac med.	Therapeutic range

No toxic, asphyxiant or narcotic agent identified. Note in particular that carboxyhaemoglobin and cyanide are both negative: the hypoxia described below is *displacement* hypoxia, not chemical asphyxia.

MEDICAL HISTORY — OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH FILE

Decedent was under specialist care for chronic cardiopulmonary insufficiency. The employer's occupational health file contains a **standing exemption dated 14 months prior to death, barring the decedent from entry to reduced-atmosphere zones** except when escorted and under continuous monitoring. The exemption is signed by the decedent and countersigned by the Facility Director.

CAUSE OF DEATH

Ia. ACUTE HYPOXIC ASPHYXIA — consequent upon exposure to a reduced-oxygen atmosphere. II. Chronic cardiopulmonary insufficiency; coronary atherosclerosis (contributory). MANNER: PENDING. Provisional determination: ACCIDENTAL.

POST-MORTEM INTERVAL — DETERMINATION

METHODOLOGY — ALGOR MORTIS

Liver temperature, recorded	32.5 °C at 00:41, 07 MAR
Normothermic baseline assumed	37.0 °C
Differential	4.5 °C
Ambient temperature at scene	20.8 °C (per responding officer intake form, ref. 25-03-0714)
Cooling constant applied for this ambient	0.9 °C / hr (see Appendix M)
Elapsed interval	$4.5 \div 0.9 = 5.00$ hr

ESTIMATED TIME OF DEATH: 19:41, 06 MARCH.**Working window, allowing ± 30 min: 19:10 — 20:10, 06 MARCH.**

Rigor was in early development in the small muscles of the face and hands and absent in the large muscle groups at examination. Lividity was present and fully blanching under pressure. Both are consistent with the interval above and do not independently narrow it.

APPENDIX M — COOLING RATE: METHODOLOGICAL NOTE

Post-mortem cooling is **not** constant. The rate of heat loss is proportional to the differential between body temperature and the temperature of the surrounding environment. This Office applies a standard constant of **0.9 °C/hr at a reference ambient of 21 °C**.

Where the ambient temperature at the place of death departs materially from that reference, the constant must be scaled before use:

$$\text{rate} = 0.9 \times (37 - \text{ambient}) \div (37 - 21)$$

AMBIENT °C	MULTIPLIER	EFFECTIVE RATE °C/HR	TYPICAL SETTING
21.0	1.00	0.90	Reference — heated interior
17.0	1.25	1.13	Unheated interior
15.0	1.38	1.24	Cellar, stairwell
10.0	1.69	1.52	Cool store, outdoors (spring)
6.0	1.94	1.74	Chilled store, archive cold room
2.0	2.19	1.97	Refrigerated unit

NOTE TO INVESTIGATING OFFICERS

The elapsed interval scales **inversely** with the multiplier. An interval computed at the reference constant may be converted to any other ambient by dividing by that ambient's multiplier. **The ambient figure supplied to this Office is taken from the scene intake form and is not independently verified by the examiner.**

Where the location of the body differs from the location of the temperature reading, the interval above must be recomputed.

EXAMINER

S. OKONJO, DEP. ME

REPORT ISSUED

07 MAR, 16:40

V. MARCHETTI — FACILITY DIRECTOR

INTERVIEWEE	MARCHETTI, V. (51)	DATE	07 MAR	COMMENCED	11:02
STATUS	WITNESS — VOLUNTARY	INTERVIEWING	DS R. ABIOLA	CAUTION	NOT ADMINISTERED

— TRANSCRIPT BEGINS 11:02 —

DS A Thank you for coming in. Can you take me through yesterday evening?

VM Of course. I left the building at about half five, went home to change, and was at the Perrin Foundation dinner at the Athenaeum from about ten to seven. It's our principal donor evening. I was there until about quarter past ten, then I drove home.

DS A Quarter past ten. You're confident of that.

VM It always runs to about then. There were forty of us. I'd have been home by eleven.

DS A Did you return to the facility at any point that evening?

VM No.

DS A Mr Renn sent you a message at 18:41.

VM He did. About the Halvorsen audit. He wanted to talk that night. I saw it in the car and thought — honestly, I thought, it can wait until the morning. Tobias ran hot about condition reports. He'd found mount damage on a Sargent last year and telephoned me at midnight about it.

DS A So you didn't reply.

VM I didn't reply.

[Pause.]

VM I've thought about very little else since one o'clock this morning.

DS A Tell me about Cold Store 3.

VM It holds the Halvorsen Bequest. Albumen prints, eighteen-sixties. The loan agreement mandates six degrees and thirty-five per cent humidity — that's not negotiable, it's written into the contract with the estate. And because it's a sealed store full of paper, it runs on oxygen reduction rather than sprinklers. Fifteen per cent. You can breathe it. You are not supposed to sit in it.

DS A Mr Renn had a medical exemption.

VM I countersigned it. I have been telling that man for fourteen months to take somebody in there with him and to wear the monitor. He treated it as an insult. He'd been in and out of that store for six weeks doing the condition audit.

DS A Who else was in the building?

VM Lena Kovaleski was working late — she often does. And Oskar Pryce on security.

DS A Anything you'd want us to know about either of them?

VM I don't want to make trouble for anyone.

DS A Go on.

VM Oskar's rounds have been a problem for months. Tobias filed on him in October — he found the vault level unchecked twice in a week. It cost Oskar his overtime and he took it very personally. I'm not suggesting anything. I'm saying that if somebody had walked that corridor at ten o'clock the way the schedule says, we would be having a different conversation.

DS A Is there anything about the Halvorsen audit itself I should know?

VM Only that it was routine and overdue. The estate wants a condition report every five years and we were late. I'd be astonished if there were anything in it beyond foxing and mount damage.

— TRANSCRIPT ENDS 11:38 —

O. PRYCE — NIGHT SECURITY SUPERVISOR

INTERVIEWEE	PRYCE, O. (44)	DATE	07 MAR	COMMENCED	09:40
STATUS	WITNESS — VOLUNTARY	INTERVIEWING	DS R. ABIOLA	CAUTION	NOT ADMINISTERED

— TRANSCRIPT BEGINS 09:40 —

DS A Walk me through your shift.

OP On at five. Rounds at six, rounds at ten, rounds at two. Between times I'm on the desk or in the loading bay office doing the paperwork.

DS A You did a ten o'clock round.

OP I did.

DS A Including B2.

OP B2's on the round. It's in the book.

DS A And Cold Store 3?

OP You don't open the cold stores on a round. You look at the panel. If the panel's green you walk on. That's the procedure and it's the procedure because of exactly what happened to him — you don't go putting your head into a fifteen per cent room to have a look round.

DS A So at ten o'clock the panel was green.

[Pause.]

OP It must have been. I'd have logged it otherwise.

DS A Then tell me about later.

OP I went round again at about twenty to twelve. Panel on CS3 was throwing a door fault. Door was ajar. I put my head in and he was there on the floor.

DS A What time was that?

OP Quarter to twelve, thereabouts.

DS A And you called us when?

OP Straight away.

DS A Straight away.

OP What are you asking me?

DS A I'm asking what time you called.

OP I don't carry a stopwatch. I found him, I checked he was gone, I did not walk into a fifteen per cent room to do it, and then I went up and I rang you. If that took me a minute or five minutes I couldn't tell you.

DS A Mr Renn filed an incident report against you in October.

OP He did.

DS A It cost you your overtime allocation.

OP Two hundred and ten a month it cost me. And I'll tell you what I told the panel — he timed it. He came down at half nine on a Tuesday knowing full well the round runs anticlockwise and B2's last. He wanted the report. He didn't like security in his vault.

DS A You hold a Level-4 credential on the suppression system.

OP Me and the Director. That's it. It's for if there's a fire and the automatics don't fire — you can dump a zone by hand from the panel in the corridor.

DS A Have you ever used it?

OP Never. Nobody has. There's an interlock on it anyway — it won't dump a zone with a body in it unless you deliberately hold the override.

DS A Where were you between half nine and eleven?

OP Rounds. Paperwork. Loading bay office, mostly.

DS A Mostly.

OP I'd like to know if I need somebody here with me.

— TRANSCRIPT ENDS 10:24 —

DR L. KOVALESKI — STAFF CONSERVATOR

INTERVIEWEE	KOVALESKI, L. (38)	DATE	07 MAR	COMMENCED	13:15
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STATUS	WITNESS — VOLUNTARY	INTERVIEWING	DC M. HALVERD	CAUTION	NOT ADMINISTERED
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— TRANSCRIPT BEGINS 13:15 —

DC H You were in the building last night.

LK Yes. I came down to B2 at about six and left at about quarter to eight.

DC H Quarter to eight.

LK Around then.

DC H What were you working on?

LK A treatment. Routine.

DC H Which object?

LK Does that matter?

DC H It might.

[Pause. Interviewee declines to answer. Question not pressed at this stage.]

DC H Did you see Mr Renn?

LK Yes. He was in and out of Cold Store 3 all evening with the Halvorsen audit. We spoke twice. The last time was — I want to say half eight, and after that I was in the wet lab with the door shut and I didn't see him again.

DC H What did you speak about?

LK He was agitated. He said the mounts were wrong on four of the Halvorsen plates. Not damaged. *Wrong*. Modern board where there should have been the original secondary support. He asked me whether I'd ever seen the estate re-mount anything and I said not to my knowledge.

DC H Did that mean something to you?

LK It meant he'd found a records problem. Somebody re-mounted them and didn't write it down. That's a disciplinary matter, it isn't —

[Interviewee does not complete the sentence.]

DC H You applied for his post.

LK Eighteen months ago. He got it. He was better qualified and he was better at it than I would have been, and I have said that out loud to people who were hoping I'd say something else.

DC H Was he in the cold store when you left?

LK I assumed so. His coat was on the hook and his tablet was on the bench. I didn't look in. You don't open a cold store to say goodnight.

DC H His tablet.

LK He carried it everywhere. He did the whole audit on it — photographs, condition notes, the lot.

DC H We haven't found a tablet.

[Pause.]

LK Then I don't know what to tell you.

— TRANSCRIPT ENDS 13:52 —

D. FERRARO — CONTRACT HANDLER, OSTRAND LOGISTICS

INTERVIEWEE	FERRARO, D. (29)	DATE	07 MAR	COMMENCED	15:05
STATUS	WITNESS — TELEPHONE	INTERVIEWING	DC M. HALVERD	CAUTION	NOT ADMINISTERED

— NOTE BEGINS 15:05 —

DC H Where were you last night?

DF Brenholt run. On the boat at twenty to six, back over on the one-twenty. It's on the sheet, it's on the manifest, and there's a fuel card at the terminal with my face on the camera. Ring Ostrand.

DC H You've been dismissed for theft before.

DF Six years ago, from a builders' merchant, for a pallet of copper pipe I did not take, and I've had it read back to me by every single person who's ever wanted something from me since. Ask me about last night.

DC H You handled the Halvorsen crates in January.

DF My crew brought them up from the dock, yeah. Four of them got pulled out for re-crating before they went into the cold store.

DC H Pulled out by whom?

DF The Director. She did it herself, in the anteroom, with the door shut. Which I thought was unusual, because normally you can't move a crate in that place without three conservators standing over you filling in a form.

DC H Did you say anything at the time?

DF Mate, I'm the man with the theft record. I signed the manifest and I went home.

— NOTE ENDS 15:19 —

FACILITY SYSTEMS — BASE EXTRACT

Extract prepared 07 MAR 14:20. Systems imaged: access control (Kestrel AC-9), vault climate telemetry, life-safety controller, conservation file server. **This extract covers Vault Level B2 only.** Other levels, and full event logs where indicated, are held by the Unit and are available on request.

1 · ACCESS CONTROL — VAULT LEVEL B2

TIMESTAMP	DIR	CREDENTIAL	READER
06 MAR 18:04:12	IN	L.KOVALESKI · 2288	B2-MAIN
06 MAR 18:15:40	IN	T.RENN · 1049	B2-MAIN
06 MAR 21:26:44	OUT	L.KOVALESKI · 2288	B2-MAIN
06 MAR 23:40:02	IN	O.PRYCE · 0117	B2-MAIN
07 MAR 00:07:31	IN	— MANUAL RELEASE —	B2-MAIN

Reader note, appended by DFU: the B2 freight-elevator door contact registered two cycles during the reporting period — 21:35:19 (car arriving at B2) and 22:31:07 (car departing B2). Neither cycle has an associated badge event *on this level*. Freight elevator calls are authorised at the originating level. Level D logs are not included in this extract.

2 · VAULT CLIMATE TELEMETRY — COLD STORE 3

TIME	TEMP °C	RH %	STATUS
06 MAR 14:00	6.0	35	NOMINAL
06 MAR 16:00	6.1	35	NOMINAL
06 MAR 18:00	6.0	35	NOMINAL
06 MAR 20:00	5.9	34	NOMINAL
06 MAR 22:00	6.0	35	NOMINAL
07 MAR 00:00	6.1	35	NOMINAL
07 MAR 00:11	6.2	36	FAULT — DOOR OPEN
07 MAR 02:00	14.8	41	FAULT — DOOR OPEN

Setpoint: 6.0 °C ± 0.5, RH 35% ± 5. Mandated by the Halvorsen Bequest loan agreement, sch. 2 §4 (albumen prints). **Telemetry is continuous and shows no excursion from setpoint at any point between 14:00 on 06 MAR and the door fault at 00:11 on 07 MAR.**

3 · LIFE-SAFETY CONTROLLER — ZONE B2-CS3 · STATUS PAGE

Zone	B2-CS3 (COLD STORE 3)
Suppression type	HYPOXIC — NITROGEN INJECTION
Nominal oxygen setpoint	15.0 %
Occupancy interlock	ACTIVE
Automatic discharges, period to date	0
Discrete events logged, reporting period	2
Detail	SEE FULL EVENT LOG — NOT INCLUDED IN THIS EXTRACT
Controller time source	NTP — SYNCHRONISED

4 · CONSERVATION FILE SERVER — WRITE LOG

TIMESTAMP	USER	FILE	WORKSTATION
06 MAR 18:22:41	t.renn	HALVORSEN_CONDITION_NOTES.docx	B2-CONS-02
06 MAR 19:33:08	t.renn	HALVORSEN_CONDITION_NOTES.docx	B2-CONS-02
06 MAR 20:22:14	t.renn	HALVORSEN_DISCREPANCY_v3.docx	B2-CONS-02
06 MAR 21:12:55	l.kovaleski	TREATMENT_LOG_MAR.xlsx	B2-WET-01
06 MAR 21:51:07	t.renn	HALVORSEN_DISCREPANCY_v4.docx	B2-CONS-02

No further write activity on this share until 07 MAR 08:14 (administrative). Document contents were not recoverable from the write log; the files themselves reside on the workstation and are available for imaging on request.

5 · SYSTEMS NOT INCLUDED IN THIS EXTRACT

Available to the investigation on request. Each requires a separate authority.

SYSTEM	HOLDER
Level D service door & freight elevator access logs	Meridian facilities
Life-safety controller — full event log, Zone B2-CS3	Meridian facilities
Guard-tour NFC checkpoint export (raw)	Kestrel AC-9 vendor
Workstation B2-CONS-02 — full disk image	DFU, pending authority
Subscriber telephone records — T. Renn	Carrier, pending authority

RECORDS & EXHIBITS

E-1.1 · SUPPRESSION SYSTEM — CREDENTIAL ROSTER

Supplied by Meridian facilities, 07 MAR. Current as at date of incident.

LEVEL	CAPABILITY	HOLDERS
L4	Manual discharge · manual vent · occupancy interlock override	MARCHETTI, V. (Director) PRYCE, O. (Night Security Supervisor)
L2	View status · acknowledge alarms	14 holders (conservation, facilities, reception)
L1	View status only	All badged staff

Manual discharge is initiated at a physical corridor panel and requires a Level-4 credential presented at that panel. The occupancy interlock prevents discharge into a zone showing occupancy; overriding it requires a deliberate, separate operator action at the same panel. There are no remote or networked discharge paths.

E-1.2 · OSTRAND LOGISTICS — RUN SHEET, D. FERRARO

TIME	ENTRY
06 MAR 17:12	Depart Ostrand yard, vehicle OL-14.
06 MAR 17:40	Boarded, Aldenmoor-Brenholt vehicle ferry. Manifest line 22, vehicle OL-14, driver D. FERRARO.
06 MAR 19:05	Fuel card 4471 — Brenholt terminal forecourt. Forecourt camera frame retained.
06 MAR 20:30 – 23:55	Brenholt depot, unload and reload. Depot gate log timestamps both movements.
07 MAR 01:20	Return crossing docks Aldenmoor.

Brenholt is 190 km from Aldenmoor by road and is reachable only by the vehicle ferry, which ran three sailings on 06 MAR. No sailing between 17:40 and 01:20 carried vehicle OL-14 in either direction.

E-1.3 · HALVORSEN BEQUEST — ACCESSION SCHEDULE (EXTRACT)

ACCESSION	OBJECT	STORE	AUDIT STATUS
HB-014	Albumen print, harbour view	B2-CS3	CLEARED
HB-021	Albumen print, quarry workings	B2-CS3	CONDITION QUERY — REF v4
HB-022	Albumen print, quarry workings (2)	B2-CS3	CONDITION QUERY — REF v4
HB-030	Albumen print, viaduct under construction	B2-CS3	CONDITION QUERY — REF v4
HB-031	Albumen print, viaduct completed	B2-CS3	CONDITION QUERY — REF v4
HB-044	Albumen print, foreshore	B2-CS3	CLEARED

Re-crating record, 14 JAN: crates for HB-021, HB-022, HB-030 and HB-031 opened and re-crated in the B2 anteroom prior to store entry. Supervising officer of the estate's own condition report: none in attendance. Meridian supervising signature: V. MARCHETTI.

E-1.4 · EXHIBITS RECOVERED

REF	ITEM	LOCATION FOUND
EX-01	Personal oxygen monitor, Meridian issue, unit 06	Charging cradle, B2 anteroom — fully charged, not deployed
EX-02	Spectacles, folded	Breast pocket of deceased
EX-03	Overcoat, wool, grey	Hook, B2 anteroom
EX-04	Lanyard and staff badge, cred. 1049	On deceased

ITEM SOUGHT, NOT RECOVERED

A tablet computer, described by two witnesses as being carried by the deceased at all times and used for the entirety of the Halvorsen condition audit. Not present in Cold Store 3, the B2 anteroom, the conservation lab, the deceased's office, his vehicle, or his home. **No search of the premises has recovered it.**